ManyDaughters PAP

Jack Fitzgerald, Essi Kujansuu
3 July 2025

H1: Having daughters leads to stronger support for gender equality (as measured by attitudes).

Variables

Outcome

Raw data:
plh0308_v1: Man/woman in equal work and household/family. Only measured in 2012.
plh0308_v2: Best if man and woman work the same amount so they can share the responsibility. Only measured in 2018.

Data processing:
We standardize the answers for 2012 and 2018 with the mean and standard deviation of each year (i.e., standardize 2012 outcome by the standard deviation of the 2018 outcomes) so that both years, we have a mean of 0 and standard deviation of 1. Code the attitude variable so that a positive and larger number indicates more agreement with equal workload between men and women.

Exposure

A dummy indicating that the respondent's first child is a daughter, rather than a son.

Controls

Factor variable for age of first child, factor variable for age of respondent, factor variable for gender of respondent, year fixed effects

Inclusion/Exclusion

1. Has valid value (1,2,3, or 4) of plh0308_v1 in 2012 or (1,2,3,4,5,6, or 7) plh0308_v2 in 2018 pl file. Note, the scale flips: "4" means "strongly disagree" in 2012 and "1" means "strongly disagree" in 2018.
2. Has only one child at the time of measurement, who is a (presumed) biological child of the respondent.

Exact Analysis

For robust standard errors for heteroskedasticity, potentially also controlling for multiple observations per individual if the case, we use vce(cluster respondent_ID)

reg standard_attitude_respondent i.first_child_daughter##i.age_of_child i.gender_respondent i.age_respondent i.year, vce(cluster respondent_ID)
margins, dydx(*)

Interpretation of Results

We test whether the average marginal effect of “first_child_daughter” is significantly different from zero with a **two-sided test, using a 0.5% significance level**.

H2: Having daughters leads to more left-leaning political preferences.

Variables

Outcome

Raw data:
pl/plh0004: In politics people often talk about “left” and “right” when it comes to characterize different political attitudes. If you think about your own political views: Where would you place yours? Collected more frequently, in 2004, 2009, 2014 and 2019. Likert scale from 0 (Far left) to 10 (Far right).

Data processing:
We standardize the answers for all the years (using the overall mean and standard deviation for all years, because the scale stays the same) so that the main variable has a mean of 0 and standard deviation of 1.

Higher value for political leaning means more support for (far) right politics.

Controls

Factor variable for age of first child, factor variable for age of respondent, factor variable for gender of respondent, year fixed effects

Inclusion

1. Has valid value (0-10) for plh0004.
2. Has only one child at the time of measurement, who is a (presumed) biological child of the respondent.

Exact Analysis

For robust standard errors for heteroskedasticity, potentially also controlling for multiple observations per respondent, we use vce(cluster respodent_ID)

reg political_leaning_respondent i.first_child_daughter##i.age_of_child i.gender_respondent i.age_respondent i.year, vce(cluster respondent_ID)
margins, dydx(*)

Interpretation of Results

We test whether the average marginal effect of “first_child_daughter” is significantly different from zero with a **two-sided test, using a 0.5% significance level**.

H3: Having daughters leads to more gender equality in the household (as measured by behaviors or outcomes).

Variables

Raw data: https://paneldata.org/soep-core/topics?open=topic_ha
Time use variables, available for all years between 2000-2020:

- hours weekdays running errands; pli0040
- hours weekday housework; pli0043_h
- hours weekday child care; pli0044_h
- hours weekday repairs; pli0049_h

Not including persons in care, work, hobbies, and training:

- Support persons in care, weekdays
- Hours Weekdays Physical Activities
- Hours Weekdays Other Hobbies
- Hours Weekdays Job, Training
- hours weekday training, education

Data processing:

- Construct the share of male household work within the household (and represent as a percentage):
- male_housework_share = (H_errands_man + H_housework_man + H_childcare_man + H_repairs_man)/(H_errands_man + H_housework_man + H_childcare_man + H_repairs_man + H_errands_woman + H_housework_woman + H_childcare_woman + H_repairs_woman)

Controls

Factor variable for age of first child, factor variable for age of respondent, factor variable for gender of respondent, year fixed effects

Inclusion/Exclusion

Include **households** that:

- Have one child only with at least one (presumed) biological parent

Exact Analysis

For robust standard errors for heteroskedasticity, potentially also controlling for multiple observations per respondent, we use vce(cluster respodent_ID)

reg male_housework_share i.first_child_daughter##i.age_of_child i.gender_respondent i.age_respondent i.year, vce(cluster respondent_ID)
margins, dydx(*)

Interpretation of Results

We test whether the average marginal effect of “first_child_daughter” is significantly different from zero with a **two-sided test, using a 0.5% significance level**.

H4: Having daughters leads to a larger increase in the support of gender equality for men than for women (with gender equality measured by attitudes).

Variables

Same as in H1.

Inclusion/Exclusion

Same as in H1.

Exact Analysis

(omitted category son_mother)
reg standard_attitude_parent i.first_child_daughter_father##i.age_of_child i.first_child_son_father##i.age_of_child i.first_child_daughter_mother##i.age_of_child i.age_respondent i.year, vce(cluster respondent_ID)
margins, dydx(*)

Interpretation of Results

We test whether the average marginal effect of “first_child_daughter_father” is significantly different from zero with a **two-sided test, using a 0.5% significance level**.